Workday: Build the Future of Work with AI Challenge

Work is changing faster than ever. AI is reshaping how people learn, grow, collaborate, and make decisions at work. For students entering the workforce, the first few months inside a company can feel especially fragmented: unfamiliar tools, scattered knowledge, unclear career paths, hidden networks, and uncertainty about which skills matter most.

For this challenge, build an AI-powered agent or prototype that helps people succeed after they join a company, whether that means ramping into a new role, finding trusted information, completing everyday workplace tasks, building skills, or discovering growth opportunities.

You do **not** need to build inside Workday. Use the tools, models, frameworks, and datasets of your choice.

What Your Team Should Submit or Demo

Your team should be prepared to show:

- The workplace problem you chose to solve
- Who the intended user is
- Your AI-powered prototype, demo, mockup, workflow, or interactive concept
- How the AI or agent works
- What the agent does autonomously
- Where the human is involved in the workflow
- What data or assumptions your solution uses
- How your solution reflects responsible AI principles
- How your solution could help a real organization

We care about the strength of the idea, the quality of the user experience, responsible AI design, and how clearly you demonstrate impact.

Workday Developer Relations Follow-Up Opportunity

In addition to any Workday Company Track prize, the winning team may be invited to meet with the Workday Developer Relations team after the hackathon to discuss their prototype, receive feedback, and explore whether the concept could become a future student innovation story, sample use case, GitHub spotlight, or Workday developer ecosystem example.

This follow-up opportunity is intended to give students a meaningful next step beyond the hackathon weekend and help Workday learn from emerging student builders.

Full Criteria

Criteria	What we're looking for	Weight
Agentic Logic & AI Innovation	Does it just talk, or does it help the user take the next step? Does the project show planning, reasoning, recommendations, workflow guidance, safe execution, or multi-step support?	30%
New Hire & Early-Career Relevance	Is the solution relevant to employees navigating a new workplace? Does it support learning, development, ramping, or career pathing?	20%
Responsible AI & Trust	Does the concept keep humans in the loop, make AI reasoning transparent, protect privacy, and consider fairness?	20%
Future of Work / Workday Relevance	Does the project connect to everyday work, skills, growth, internal mobility, employee experience, workforce decisions, or other workplace challenges?	15%
User Experience & Inclusivity	Is the experience useful, accessible, supportive, and designed for people from different backgrounds?	10%
Pitch, Execution & Storytelling	Is the prototype or walkthrough a creative solution and clearly demonstrates the problem, solution, and impact?	5%

If you would like more information, you can see more details below 🔽

More Details

Why Choose the Workday Track?

This track is for builders who want to use AI to solve real problems people face at work.

Many students know what it feels like to start something new: a class, internship, research lab, club, project, or first job. You have to learn quickly, find the right people, understand unfamiliar systems, and figure out how to grow. Now imagine solving that challenge at the scale of a global company.

The Workday track gives you the chance to build AI agents that help people ramp faster, learn smarter, find opportunity, and make better decisions, while keeping humans in control.

Winning teams may also be invited to meet with Workday Developer Relations after the hackathon to discuss their prototype and explore whether the concept could become a future student innovation story, sample use case, GitHub spotlight, or Workday developer ecosystem example.

Your solution could help early-career employees, interns, new grads, managers, mentors, or HR teams answer questions like:

- How do I ramp up faster in a new role?
- What skills do I need to grow?
- What internal opportunities fit my goals?
- Who can help me learn or unblock my work?
- How can managers better support early-career talent?
- How can AI agents help employees take action while keeping humans in control?
- How can workplace decisions become more transparent, fair, and human-centered?

Pro Tips for a Strong Submission

Build an Agent That Takes the Next Step
A chatbot answers questions. An agent helps a user move toward a goal. It can understand intent, plan steps, use information, prepare actions, ask for approval, and help the user complete a task safely.

Keep It Focused
A focused agent that does one thing extremely well will be stronger than a broad “do everything” assistant that is hard to understand or demo.

Show the Human-in-the-Loop
Make it clear where the human reviews, approves, edits, or rejects the agent’s recommendation. This is especially important for workplace decisions.

Show the Trust Factor
Tell us why the user should trust the agent. What does the agent show on screen to prove it is acting safely and responsibly?

Make It Human
Give your agent a useful personality or interaction style. It could feel like a supportive career coach, a practical onboarding buddy, a thoughtful manager assistant, or a no-nonsense technical guide.

Tell a Clear Story
The best projects will make the problem feel real, show how the agent helps, and explain why the solution matters for the future of work.

Design for Trust

Because your solution may touch workplace decisions, trust matters.

As you design, show how the user knows:

- What the AI is doing
- Why it made a recommendation
- What data it used
- What action it wants to take
- Where the user can approve, edit, or reject the recommendation
- What the system will not do
- When a human needs to be involved
- What happens when the AI is uncertain
- How the user can correct or challenge the AI

Strong projects will make the AI's reasoning visible and keep humans in control of important decisions.

For low-risk tasks, an agent might prepare or complete an action. For higher-impact tasks, such as benefits, compensation, access permissions, financial approvals, or anything affecting employment records, the agent should explain the recommendation and require human review or approval. The agent should not make final decisions about employment, compensation, performance, benefits eligibility, or access without appropriate human oversight.

Responsible AI at Workday

At Workday, we believe great AI is not just smart; it is responsible. Because this challenge involves workplace decisions that can affect people's careers, growth, opportunities, and employee experience, your solution should be designed with trust from the start.

Workday's Responsible AI principles include:

Transparent

- Users should understand what the AI is doing and why.
- Your project should make it clear when AI is being used, what information it considered, and how it reached a recommendation.

Fair

- AI should not introduce or amplify bias. It should work equitably for different people and groups.
- Your project should consider whether recommendations could advantage or disadvantage certain users, roles, backgrounds, geographies, or career paths.

Accountable

- Humans should remain involved in high-impact workplace decisions.
- Your project should show where a human reviews, approves, edits, or overrides the AI, especially when recommendations could affect someone's job, career, compensation, performance, or opportunities.

Privacy-Preserving

- Data used by AI must be handled with care and respect for individuals.
- Your project should avoid unnecessary personal data, explain what data is used, and protect sensitive information.

Reliable

- AI should behave consistently and predictably, especially in enterprise contexts.
- Your project should consider how the AI handles uncertainty, missing information, edge cases, or conflicting data.

Tools and Data

You do not need to build inside Workday. Use any tools, models, frameworks, or datasets you choose.

You may use:

- Public data
- Synthetic data
- Data you create yourself
- Mock data
- Simulated user profiles
- Fictional company scenarios

Do **not** use confidential, personal, or real employee data.

If helpful, you can create sample data using fields like:

- Employee ID
- Department
- Location
- Job title
- Job family
- Level
- Tenure
- Skills
- Interests
- Desired next role
- Role requirements
- Learning recommendations
- Open projects
- Internal opportunities
- Manager goals
- Team skill needs
- Mentor profiles
- Project descriptions
- Onboarding tasks
- Documentation links
- Promotion criteria
- Policy scenarios